BUSINESS & DEVELOPMENT MASTER PLAN

منيو يليق بمكانك

The café, run *beautifully*.

One system for the menu, the waiter, the kitchen, the till and the numbers. Sold on a monthly plan. Introduced without interrupting a single service.

PREPARED
29 October 2026

MARKET
Egypt · cafés & restaurants

CURRENCY
EGP, estimates

LEAD MODEL
Monthly subscription

Chapter one

Executive summary

350
EGP / MONTH · ENTRY QR MENU

3
VENUES TO BREAK EVEN

0
HARDWARE THE VENUE MUST BUY

elmenue is already built. The work now is to sell it, price it clearly and switch each venue over without ever stopping service.

1 · Pricing

Lead with a monthly plan from 350 to 1,450 EGP. Keep a one-time licence of 20,000 to 80,000 EGP, plus 12% yearly support, for owners who refuse a subscription.

2 · Safety

Every venue goes live shadow-first. The old way of working stays beside elmenue until the owner has watched it succeed and signed the handover.

3 · Compliance gate

Ask each prospect on day one whether they must issue ETA e-receipts. Sell to those who do not, and build or partner for ETA as the first paid feature.

Chapter two

Market & competitors

Venues in Egypt already pay monthly for QR menus, cloud POS and online ordering. You are selling into a paid habit. Prices come from vendor pages in your market study and are indicative.

Who buys

SEGMENT	SIZE	PAIN	BEST TIER
Kiosk, takeaway, small café	up to ~10 tables	Printed menus, no budget for POS hardware	Basic
Café or casual restaurant	~10–30 tables	Overloaded waiters, lost orders, no sales data	Operations · core target
Lounge, large restaurant, small chain	30+ tables, zones	Control, loyalty, branch reporting	VIP
Hotels, clubs, food courts	multi-outlet	Brand look, reporting	VIP, custom

Competitors & your edge

COMPETITOR TYPE	PRICE SEEN	YOUR EDGE
QR menu only · OrOMenu, Orders Egypt	100–200 EGP / month	You add ordering, kitchen, bill split and POS
Cloud POS · Foodics, Geidea, Odoo, local	1,000–5,000 EGP / month + 7,500–22,000 hardware	Browser only, runs on tablets they own, Arabic first
Online ordering · Ordable-type	28,000–45,000 EGP / year	They do delivery, you do dine-in
Per-order QR · Queno	Flat fee per order	Fixed price, no fee growing with sales
Dgtera · VeraKit360	Not published; trial or sales call	Built for larger operators; you win on price and simplicity for independent cafés
Zlenu	Free plan, paid amounts not shown	Closest rival: QR menu and ordering beside the cashier. You win on POS, inventory, Franco and the one-time option
Besalla	$50–$150 / month	Branded app and delivery focus; you do dine-in
BIM POS Egypt · contactless menu	Not public; hotline only	Menu tied to their POS. Yours works on its own and on any device

RESEARCH RESULT · FROM THEIR OWN WEBSITES, 29 OCT 2026

All five vendors are real and sell in Egypt. Only Foodics, Besalla and Ordable publish prices. Dgtera and VeraKit360 hide prices behind a trial or a sales call, and Zlenu shows plan limits and discounts but not amounts on its site. Where a price is missing it says so below; get a quote as a customer to fill the gap.

Competitor teardown

VENDOR	WHAT IT IS	PUBLISHED PRICE	HOW BUNDLES ARE CUT
Foodics	Cloud POS and restaurant management. Egypt phone 15796. Paymob card terminals through Banque Misr.	Basic 2,848.95–3,019.89 EGP / month Advanced 3,733.67–3,957.69 EGP / month (billed annually; page does not say which figure is which)	Basic: POS, menu, customers, dashboards, reports, inventory, tables, coupons, promotions. Advanced adds loyalty, API, online ordering website, delivery aggregators, BI. Extras sold as paid add-ons: web cashier, digital receipts, cloud kitchen. Hardware and add-on prices are not shown.
Zlenu	QR menu, table ordering, captain, kitchen display, loyalty, AI menu reading. Not a POS; runs beside the existing cashier. WhatsApp +20 114 388 7000.	Amounts not shown on the site. Free, Menu, Pro, Premium plans. Quarterly billing 11% off, yearly 22% off. 14-day trial on paid plans.	Same features on every plan. Plans differ only by limits: Free = 1 branch, 1 user, 20 dishes, 5 tables. Menu = 2 branches, 5 users. Pro = 3 branches, 20 users. Premium = unlimited. Pays by card, wallet or Fawry.
Dgtera	Saudi company, POS, accounting, kiosk, online menu, call centre. Lists Fawry and Geidea integrations; claims 700+ customers.	Not published. Plans Basic, Advanced, Enterprise; 14-day free trial.	Website shows an identical 16-feature list for all three plans, so the real difference is likely branches, devices or support. Ask in a demo.
VeraKit360	Full restaurant operating platform by Veragates: POS, KDS, inventory, procurement, food cost, finance, HR, payroll, delivery, loyalty, apps.	Not published. 15-day free trial.	Sold by footprint: single branch, 2–5 branches, enterprise, cloud kitchen. No Egypt mention on the site.
Besalla	Branded mobile app, online ordering, self-	Basic $50, Advanced $100, Comprehensive	Basic: app, ordering, one payment option. Advanced:

	order, cashier, WhatsApp AI ordering assistant. Based in Riyadh, with Egyptian phone numbers. No commissions.	$150 per month (USD).	more payment options, wallets, notifications, basic analytics, loyalty. Comprehensive: advanced analytics, marketing notifications, multi-branch, CRM and API, priority support.
Ordable	Online ordering website and delivery.	Launch 28,000 EGP / year (2 branches). Scale 45,000 EGP / year (5 branches). No commission.	Scale adds loyalty, abandoned-cart recovery, popup banners, account manager.

How they price, and what to copy

Foodics anchors the top

About 2,850–3,960 EGP a month for the cloud POS, with extras on top. Your Operations tier at 850–1,000 EGP is roughly a quarter to a third of that. Say it as a saving: "about 25,000–35,000 EGP less per year". Do not claim to replace its POS or tax features.

Zlenu is your closest rival

It does what you do beside the cashier: QR menu, table ordering, captain, kitchen, loyalty, AI menu scan. It has a free plan, 14-day trials, discounts of 11% and 22% for longer billing, and gates plans by limits, not features. Your Basic tier at 350 EGP must beat a free plan limited to 20 dishes and 5 tables.

Everyone else sells to chains

Dgtera and VeraKit360 hide prices and sell demos to larger operators. Besalla and Ordable sell branded apps and websites for delivery. A small independent café is least served, and that is where Basic and Operations fit.

What this changes in your offer

OBSERVATION	CHANGE TO MAKE
Every rival offers a 14 or 15-day free trial	Match it: 14 days free on a real table, in place of the one-table-only week
Zlenu gates by limits (branches, users, dishes, tables)	Add limits to your tiers too, so a 5-table café fits Basic and a 30-table one needs Operations
Zlenu discounts 11% quarterly and 22% yearly	Offer 10% quarterly and 20% yearly in place of "two months free", so the comparison looks equal
Zlenu has a free plan	Consider a free tier limited to a few tables and dishes, or keep Basic at 350 EGP and win on ordering, kitchen and Ammiya/Franco
Nobody lists a one-time price	Your one-time licence is a real difference; lead with it only for owners who dislike subscriptions
Foodics sells loyalty, API and online ordering only in the Advanced bundle	Your VIP tier already bundles loyalty, AI scan and copilot at 1,450 EGP; present it as "Foodics Advanced features at less than half the price", but only for the features you really have
Besalla and Ordable charge no commission	State "no commission, ever" in your pitch
Zlenu accepts card, wallet and Fawry for its own subscription	Offer Fawry, InstaPay and wallet payment for your subscription
Foodics and Dgtera integrate Paymob, Fawry, Geidea	Plan card payments through one of these; it is the most asked-for gap

Sources: Foodics Egypt pricing · Zlenu · Dgtera · Dgtera packages · VeraKit360 · Besalla · Ordable Egypt pricing. Prices copied from the vendors' own pages on 29 Oct 2026 and may change. Foodics prices are quoted as two figures because the page does not label which applies to which billing period.

REFERENCE PRICE SEEN	FIGURE	SOURCE STATUS
Orders Egypt QR menu	200 EGP / month · 900 / 6 months · 1,500 / year	Vendor page
Queno	No subscription, flat fee per completed order	Vendor page, amount not shown
QR plus POS, general estimate	300–1,500 EGP / month	Comparison blog
Foodics Egypt	2,849–3,020 EGP / month Basic · 3,734–3,958 EGP / month Advanced	Vendor page

POSITIONING

Your menu, your waiter, your kitchen screen and your reports, on the phones you already own, in the Arabic your guests speak.

The Egyptian market at a glance

MEASURE	FIGURE	SOURCE AND CAUTION
Foodservice market, 2025	USD 10.4 bn (Mordor) to 12.4 bn (IMARC)	Mordor · IMARC. The two sources differ by about 20%
Growth forecast	About 15% a year, 2026–2031 (Mordor); USD 11.9 bn in 2026	Forecast, not actual
Coffee shops, 2025	USD 1.8 bn, about 4.6% a year to 2034. Independent cafés are the largest format	Deep Market Insights. Independents are your target
Cloud kitchens	USD 487 m in 2025, about double by 2031	Ken Research. A later upsell, not today's product
Number of outlets	No reliable current count found. About 18,300 institutions cited for 2022	USDA report, dated. Buy the Euromonitor unit counts or ask CAPMAS
Your reachable pool	20,000 venues with 5+ tables in Cairo, Giza and Alexandria	Planning assumption, not a statistic. 25 venues is 0.1% of it

What is changing in the market

New entrants

Qatar's DineNORDER announced its Egypt launch in August 2026 with ordering, POS, reservations and inventory. Wamda. Foreign and Saudi vendors are moving in; being local, Arabic first and fast to support is your defence.

Payments are bundled

Foodics partnered with Paymob for card terminals in Egypt, GrubTech enrols its venues with Paymob automatically, and Simple Touch added Fawry. Foodics. Leaders earn from payments, not only software. Plan a gateway partnership.

E-receipts

The tax authority rolls out electronic receipts by named taxpayer, in waves, and sources disagree on dates. A venue can check whether its registration number is on the authority's e-receipt inquiry page. Guide. Check each prospect before you promise anything.

How the best operators do it

PRACTICE	WHO DOES IT	WHAT YOU DO
Core bundle, paid add-ons	Foodics	Keep three clean tiers; sell printer setup, cards and design as add-ons
Same features, different limits	Zlenu	Add table, staff and branch limits so the price follows the venue's size
Free entry plan and 14-day trials	Zlenu, Dgtera, VeraKit360	14 days free on a real table; a tiny free tier only if it feeds paid upgrades
Discount for paying longer	Zlenu 11% quarterly, 22% yearly	10% quarterly, 20% yearly. Cash earlier, churn lower
No commission on orders	Ordable, Besalla	Say it in every pitch
Local payment methods for their own subscription	Zlenu: card, wallet, Fawry	Accept Fawry, InstaPay and wallets from day one
Named account manager on the top plan	Ordable Scale	Priority WhatsApp support on VIP
Compliance first	Foodics, Odoo partners	ETA e-receipts as your first paid module

Chapter three

The product, tier by tier

Three tiers are enforced in code. Each higher tier includes everything below it. Hollow markers are planned, not built.

- Digital menu with six layouts and category photos
- Instant micro-services: water, napkins, cutlery, call waiter
- Menu admin: categories, items, photos, sold-out in one tap
- Home screen with branding, promotions and Wi-Fi tap-to-copy
- Everything in Basic
- Review screen, then “add more items” loop
- Waiter app: floor map, tickets, accept orders, push alerts
- Party size, table host, reservations, move and merge tables
- Discounts with a captain cap, voids with a reason
- Table QR codes carrying a secret table key
- Sound alert with the exact table number
- Dietary tags and timed categories
- Guests cannot order in this tier
- Guest ordering with a shared table cart
- Pending window to edit, then kitchen lock enforced by the server
- Kitchen display by station with timers
- Staff POS: takeaway and delivery tickets
- Cash, card or mixed payment, tips, 80 mm receipt

- ◆ Split the bill: self, table or custom
- ◆ English, Egyptian Ammiya and Franco
- ◆ Everything in Operations
- ◆ EGP-to-points and points-to-EGP ratios you set
- ◆ Admin AI copilot: “what sold best this week?”
- ◆ Multi-branch analytics by group
- ◇ ETA live (production) submission NEEDS ETA REGISTRATION
- ◇ WhatsApp receipts and order sharing
- ◇ Cross-branch menu sync
- ◇ Automatic kitchen printing
- ◆ Inventory: stock counts, low-stock alerts, waste log
- ◆ Staff PIN accounts, audit trail, Excel and CSV reports
- ◆ Loyalty card by phone number
- ◆ AI photo menu scan: paper menu to digital menu
- ◆ Premium themes: Dark Neon Glass, Minimalist Luxury, Vibrant Egyptian Café, and 24 more
- ◆ Member list, manual point adjustments, daily loyalty figures
- ◇ First real Paymob payment NEEDS PAYMOB ACCOUNT
- ◇ Recipe costing and supplier orders
- ◇ SMS verification for loyalty

Pages, by who sees them

Guest · Home, Menu, My order and Review, Bill, Profile, Loyalty card.

Waiter · Floor map or zone list, table dialog, tickets, reservations, POS, pay dialog.

Kitchen · Ticket board with timers, ready button, sold-out.

Owner · Analytics, Menu builder, Inventory, Orders, Floor editor, Staff, Reports, Theme, QR codes, Audit, Loyalty, AI scan, Copilot, Branches.

You · Platform console: tenants, tiers, suspension, domains, monthly revenue.

Statistics & reports

Statistics · Revenue and profit against last period, revenue by day and hour, sales by category, best sellers, rush hours, table usage, low stock, loyalty points earned and redeemed, branch revenue. Each block exports to CSV and can be cleared without deleting a single sale.

Reports · Daily sales, orders with receipt reprint, discounts and voids, sales by staff and order type, estimated profit, stock movements, full backup, audit trail.

Chapter four

The three subscriptions

Each banner lists every feature the venue gets in that tier, including everything inherited from the tier below. Prices are monthly list prices; yearly billing is the effective monthly price.

◆ Added in this tier ◇ Inherited from a lower tier

TIER ONE

Basic QR Menu

A beautiful scan-only menu that also calls the waiter. For kiosks, takeaways and small cafés.

450 EGP / MONTH

Quarterly, 10% off	**405 / month**
Yearly, 20% off	**360 / month**

Proposed limits: 1 branch · up to 10 tables · 1 owner login. Guests cannot order in this tier.

INCLUDED · 12 FEATURES

- ◆ Digital menu with six layouts and category photos
- ◆ Table QR codes with a secret table key
- ◆ Printable QR table stands
- ◆ Instant micro-services: water, napkins, cutlery, call waiter
- ◆ Sound alert with the exact table number

- Menu admin: categories, items, photos, sold-out in one tap
- Dietary tags and timed categories
- Excel menu import and bulk photo upload
- Home screen: branding, promotions, Wi-Fi tap-to-copy
- Default language of your choice
- Basic analytics
- Daily off-site backups

CORE PLAN

TIER TWO

Operations

The full café floor: guests order, waiters accept, the kitchen cooks, the till closes. For cafés and restaurants of 10–30 tables.

950 EGP / MONTH

Quarterly, 10% off	**855 / month**
Yearly, 20% off	**760 / month**

Proposed limits: 1 branch · up to 30 tables · 10 staff accounts.

EVERYTHING INCLUDED · 42 FEATURES

- ◇ Digital menu with six layouts and category photos
- ◇ Table QR codes with a secret table key
- ◇ Printable QR table stands
- ◇ Instant micro-services: water, napkins, cutlery, call waiter
- ◇ Sound alert with the exact table number
- ◇ Menu admin: categories, items, photos, sold-out in one tap
- ◇ Dietary tags and timed categories
- ◇ Excel menu import and bulk photo upload
- ◇ Home screen: branding, promotions, Wi-Fi tap-to-copy
- ◇ Default language of your choice
- ◇ Basic analytics

- ◇ Daily off-site backups
- ◆ Guest ordering with a shared table cart
- ◆ Review screen and "add more items" loop
- ◆ Pending window, then server-enforced kitchen lock
- ◆ Party size and table host
- ◆ Waiter app: floor map, zone list, tickets
- ◆ Push alerts and installable app
- ◆ Kitchen display by station with timers
- ◆ Ready alerts to waiter and guest
- ◆ Staff POS ordering at any table
- ◆ Takeaway and delivery tickets
- ◆ Discounts with a captain cap, voids with a reason
- ◆ Cash, card or mixed payment, tips, change
- ◆ 80 mm receipt print and reprint
- ◆ Split bill: self, table or custom
- ◆ Move and merge tables, reservations
- ◆ Floor-plan editor with zones
- ◆ Inventory: counts, low-stock, waste, movement log
- ◆ English, Egyptian Ammiya and Franco
- ◆ Staff PIN accounts and roles
- ◆ Full analytics with CSV export per block
- ◆ Excel reports, order history, sales by staff, profit estimate
- ◆ Audit trail and full backup export

- Upsell suggestions in the guest cart
- Guest feedback with Google review link
- Coupons and timed offers
- Online card / wallet payment (Paymob)
- ETA e-receipts (test and pre-production)
- Shift close, X and Z reports
- Offline order queue for staff apps
- Plan limits per tier

MOST COMPLETE

TIER THREE

Enterprise VIP & AI

Loyalty, AI and the premium look, for lounges, large restaurants and small chains.

1,450 EGP / MONTH

Quarterly, 10% off	1,305 / month
Yearly, 20% off	1,160 / month

Proposed limits: up to 3 branches · unlimited tables and staff. Extra branch at 50%.

EVERYTHING INCLUDED · 53 FEATURES

- ◇ Digital menu with six layouts and category photos
- ◇ Table QR codes with a secret table key
- ◇ Printable QR table stands
- ◇ Instant micro-services: water, napkins, cutlery, call waiter
- ◇ Sound alert with the exact table number
- ◇ Menu admin: categories, items, photos, sold-out in one tap
- ◇ Dietary tags and timed categories
- ◇ Excel menu import and bulk photo upload
- ◇ Home screen: branding, promotions, Wi-Fi tap-to-copy
- ◇ Default language of your choice
- ◇ Basic analytics
- ◇ Daily off-site backups

- Guest ordering with a shared table cart
- Review screen and “add more items” loop
- Pending window, then server-enforced kitchen lock
- Party size and table host
- Waiter app: floor map, zone list, tickets
- Push alerts and installable app
- Kitchen display by station with timers
- Ready alerts to waiter and guest
- Staff POS ordering at any table
- Takeaway and delivery tickets
- Discounts with a captain cap, voids with a reason
- Cash, card or mixed payment, tips, change
- 80 mm receipt print and reprint
- Split bill: self, table or custom
- Move and merge tables, reservations
- Floor-plan editor with zones
- Inventory: counts, low-stock, waste, movement log
- English, Egyptian Ammiya and Franco
- Staff PIN accounts and roles
- Full analytics with CSV export per block
- Excel reports, order history, sales by staff, profit estimate
- Audit trail and full backup export
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- ◇ Guest feedback with Google review link
- ◇ Coupons and timed offers
- ◇ Online card / wallet payment (Paymob)
- ◇ ETA e-receipts (test and pre-production)
- ◇ Shift close, X and Z reports
- ◇ Offline order queue for staff apps
- ◇ Plan limits per tier
- ◆ Loyalty card by phone number
- ◆ EGP-to-points and redemption ratios you set
- ◆ Member list and manual point adjustments
- ◆ AI photo menu scan
- ◆ Admin AI copilot
- ◆ 27 premium themes incl. Dark Neon Glass and Minimalist Luxury
- ◆ Multi-branch analytics by group
- ◆ Custom domain for the venue
- ◆ Priority WhatsApp support
- ◆ Gift cards
- ◆ Monthly owner report (planned)

Limits are proposed, following how Zlenu separates its plans. The code does not enforce them yet; tier features are enforced today. Hollow “planned” items are marked in the text.

Chapter five

Pricing & the numbers

Monthly leads. The one-time licence is the answer for owners who refuse a subscription. Quotes expire in 7 to 14 days because the pound moves.

BASIC QR MENU

350–500 EGP / MONTH

- Menu and table QR codes
- Micro-service buttons
- Menu admin
- Setup fee 1,000–2,000

OPERATIONS

850–1,000 EGP / MONTH

- Everything in Basic
- Guest ordering, waiter, kitchen, POS
- Inventory and reports
- Setup fee 3,000–5,000

VIP

1,450+ EGP / MONTH

- Everything in Operations
- Loyalty, AI scan, copilot
- Premium themes, branch analytics
- Setup fee 5,000–8,000

Extra branch at 50% of the tier. 20% off yearly, 10% off quarterly, 14-day free trial.

Add-ons

Printer and cash drawer setup 1,500–3,000 EGP. Card payments 3,000–8,000 EGP once built. Custom work 500–1,000 EGP an hour. QR table stands 100–250 EGP each. Hardware at cost plus 10–15%.

Pricing rules

Never below 15,000 EGP once or 350 EGP a month. Discounts only for pilots, annual prepay and extra branches. Confirm VAT, company form and your own e-invoicing duty with an accountant before the first invoice.

Chapter six

The business model

How you earn, what it costs you, and the ratios an investor or a banker would ask for. All figures are EGP and come from your Egypt market study unless marked as an assumption. Move the three sliders to see the effect.

How you earn money

STREAM	WHAT YOU CHARGE	COST TO YOU	ROLE IN THE BUSINESS
Subscriptions	450 / 950 / 1,450 per month	About 150 per venue a month to host and run	The engine. About 84% cash margin and the number that makes the company worth something
Setup and onboarding fee	1,500 / 4,000 / 6,500 (blended 3,500)	About 1,500 cash plus 12–20 hours of your time	Pays for winning the venue, so growth does not drain cash
One-time licence plus 12% yearly support	20,000 / 40,000 / 80,000, then 2,400–9,600 a year	Same setup cost, plus hosting for years	For owners who refuse a subscription. Include one year of hosting, then charge
Hardware resale	Cost plus 10–15%	Pass-through	Convenience, not profit. Order only after payment
QR table stands and printing	About 1.5 × cost (cost 100–250 each) [assumption]	Material and printing	Small margin, big visibility
Add-ons	Printer and drawer setup 1,500–3,000. Card payments 3,000–8,000 once built. Custom work 500–1,000 an hour	Your time	Fills quiet weeks
Menu entry, photography, design	1,000–5,000 per venue [assumption]	Your time or a freelancer	Removes the owner's biggest barrier
Partner commission (future)	Share of payment-processing fees from a gateway such as Paymob or Fawry	Integration work	Not agreed with anyone. Ask for it when you negotiate the integration

What it costs you to run

FIXED YEARLY COST	EGP	NOTE
Hosting	12,000	About 1,000 a month; one server serves many venues
Domain and monitoring	4,000	
Off-site backups	3,000	Non-negotiable
Registration, licences, legal review	10,000	Sole proprietorship or small company
Accountant	24,000	About 2,000 a month
Marketing	20,000	Demo videos, printed cards, photography
Contingency	10,000	Spares, refunds, tools
Total fixed	**83,000**	About 6,900 a month

Variable: about 150 a month per venue for hosting share, AI usage, SMS and tools [assumption]. About 1,500 cash to win each venue. Venues pay their own card fees to their gateway (about 2.75% + 3 EGP per card payment, unconfirmed). Tax is not included: corporate tax is 22.5% in general and a simplified small-business regime may apply; VAT needs an accountant's answer.

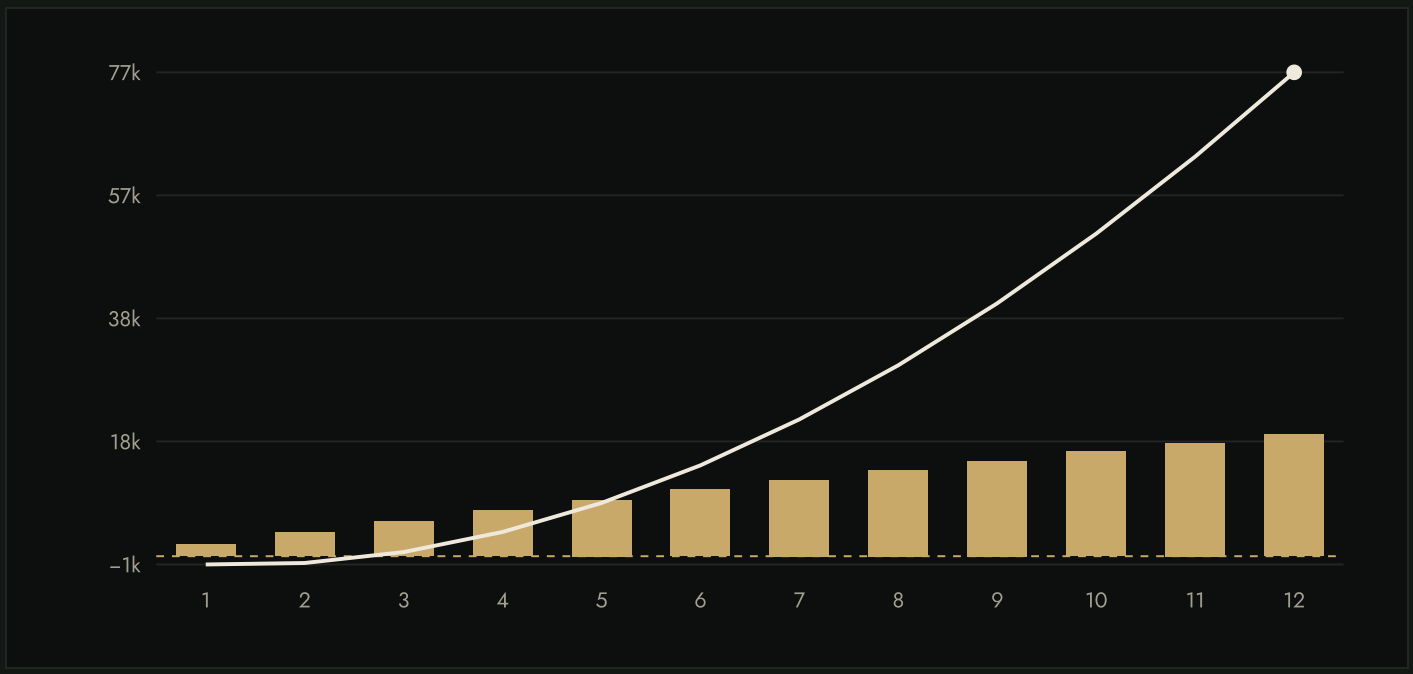
The live model

NEW PAYING VENUES A MONTH: **2**

AVERAGE REVENUE PER VENUE (EGP / MONTH): **950**

MONTHLY CHURN, VENUES LEAVING: **3.0%**

19,390 MONTHLY RECURRING REVENUE, MONTH 12 EGP	**232,680** ANNUAL RUN-RATE EGP, MRR × 12	**217,057** YEAR-ONE REVENUE subscriptions plus setup fees
77,048 YEAR-ONE PROFIT before tax and your time	**Month 3** CASH BREAK-EVEN cumulative cash reaches zero	



Monthly recurring revenue — Cumulative cash after all costs dashed line = zero. Months 1–12 along the bottom.

Unit economics, per venue

84%
CASH GROSS MARGIN
before your time

37%

Where each 100 EGP of revenue goes

Fixed costs	38%
Variable cost of serving venues	10%
Winning new venues (cash)	17%
Profit before tax and your time	35%

FULLY LOADED MARGIN

with 1.5 h support a month at 300 EGP / h

6,833

COST TO WIN A VENUE

EGP: marketing share + 1,500 cash + 15 h of your time

26,667

LIFETIME GROSS PROFIT

EGP over an expected 33 months

3.9 : 1

LIFETIME VALUE TO COST

published target: 3 : 1 or better

4.2

PAYBACK, MONTHS

after the setup fee; target 6–12

Subscriptions share of revenue 61%

Three scenarios from the same assumptions

PACE	VENUES SIGNED	ACTIVE, MONTH 12	MRR, MONTH 12	YEAR-ONE REVENUE	YEAR-ONE PROFIT	CASH BREAK-EVEN
Slow · 1 new venue a month	12	10	9,695	108,529	−2,976	After month 12
Base · 2 new venues a month	24	20	19,390	217,057	77,048	Month 3
Fast · 4 new venues a month	48	41	38,780	434,114	237,096	Month 1

How to read it, as a business

Setup fees fund growth

A blended 3,500 setup fee covers the 1,500 cash cost of each new venue and part of your time. That is why growth does not drain your cash in year one.

Churn is the lever

Monthly churn of 3% means a venue stays 33 months. At 6% it stays 17 and lifetime value halves. The monthly owner report, WhatsApp support and a loyalty feature the owner depends on keep churn low.

Your time is the real cost

Cash margin looks like 84%. Count 1.5 support hours a month and it is about 37%. Training videos, a printed card and a clean handover are what make the second hundred venues cheaper than the first ten.

BENCHMARK	PUBLISHED GUIDE	SOURCE
Lifetime value to acquisition cost	3 : 1 to 4 : 1 for small-restaurant software; early MENA stage 2 : 1	SaaS Hero · upGrowth
Payback	Early 12–18 months, growth 6–12, scale under 6	upGrowth
Monthly churn	1.5–2.5% best in class in MENA; under 5% healthy for vertical software	upGrowth · Kolonell
Gross margin	60%+ early, 70%+ growth, 75%+ scale	upGrowth

These are vendor and consultancy benchmarks, not audited market data. No restaurant-specific Egyptian churn or acquisition figures were found; replace the assumptions here with your own after the pilots.

Chapter seven

What you can sell

Sell the owner's worry, then prove the answer on their own phone with the live demo.

OWNER WORRY	WHAT ELMENUE DOES	SHOW THEM
Waiters are overloaded	Guests order and call for water or napkins from the phone	Micro-service alert with table number
Wrong or lost orders	Orders reach the kitchen screen with a timer	Kitchen display
Staff leakage	Voids need a reason, discounts are capped, every action is logged	Audit and voids report
"I don't know my real profit"	Revenue, cost, profit, best sellers and rush hours	Analytics page
Slow table turnover	Split the bill and request it from the phone	Bill tab
Guests don't return	Loyalty card by phone number	VIP card demo
Reprinting menus costs money	Edit a price once, live everywhere	Menu builder
Tourists and youth	Ammiya, English and Franco	Language switch
No budget for hardware	Runs on phones and tablets they own	Cost comparison
Typing a menu is painful	Photo scan and Excel import	AI scan

FUNNEL

Walk-in visits, Arabic demo clips, WhatsApp Business, referrals. First meeting in 15 minutes: ask about e-receipts and their POS, then show the demo. A free one-table QR trial for a week. Proposal within 24 hours.

OBJECTIONS

Internet drops? The old process stays beside you at first. **Will it stop my work?** No, shadow mode comes first. **Foodics is bigger?** It costs more and needs hardware.

RETENTION

A one-page monthly report on WhatsApp, a quarterly menu refresh, loyalty campaign templates, and upgrade prompts when a Basic venue asks about ordering.

Chapter eight

Zero-downtime rollout

Agile development with DevOps habits, introduced by pilot and then in phases, with payments run in parallel. A venue never depends on elmenue until it has proven itself beside the old process.

WEEK 0 · OLD PROCESS STILL RUNNING

Prepare offline

Import the menu, photos, tables and staff into a private copy. The owner checks every price. Guests see nothing.

WEEK 1 · OLD PROCESS STILL RUNNING

QR-only trial

One QR on one or two tables, ordering switched off. If anything fails, remove the stand and service is unchanged.

WEEK 2 · OLD PROCESS STILL RUNNING

Shadow mode

Guests order on the phone while staff also run the old way. Compare totals at close; every difference becomes a bug.

WEEK 3 · OLD PROCESS STILL RUNNING

Quiet hours live

Mornings and weekday afternoons run on elmenue. The old process waits on the counter.

WEEK 4 · OLD PROCESS STILL RUNNING

Payments in parallel

Cash and card are recorded in both systems for five to seven days until daily totals match to the pound.

WEEK 5 ONWARD · OLD PROCESS STILL RUNNING

Peak hours

Only after a quiet week with zero blocking bugs and an experienced person on every shift. Paper chits stay in a drawer for 30 days.

DAY 30

Retire the old process

Only when the owner signs the handover record.

Go / no-go gates

GATE	PASSES WHEN
Data	Owner verified menu, prices, tax and service charge
Devices	Tested on the venue's own phones, tablet and printer for a full shift
Staff	Every waiter and kitchen user finished a 20-minute drill
Money	Parallel totals matched for five days in a row
Rescue	One-page "if the app is down" card at the counter with your WhatsApp number
Backup	Last backup restored successfully on a test copy

Technical safety net

Separate production, staging and preview environments. Deploys only outside service hours, one change at a time, each tagged so rollback takes under five minutes. New modules ship switched off and are enabled per venue. Every data change must tolerate old data. Nightly off-site backups with a weekly restore test. Automated tests for billing, order lock, loyalty and tenant isolation run before every release. Uptime and error alerts go to your phone.

First sprint: hardening

Rotate the Supabase key and every token ever shared in chat. Change the live owner password and captain PIN. Rate-limit logins. Confirm every route checks the venue. Move off the Vercel free plan, which is non-commercial, before the first paid venue. Add SMS verification before storing real customer phone numbers. Have a lawyer review the contract and privacy clause.

Chapter nine

Migration, venue by venue

Every path ends with the same promise: the old process stays usable until the owner signs.

VENUE STARTS WITH	RISK	PATH	ROLLBACK
Paper menu, no POS	LOW	QR trial, shadow, quiet hours, peak	Keep paper chits
Another QR menu	LOW	Run both stands for two weeks, then remove theirs	Their stand stays until stable
Existing POS	HIGH	elmenue does guest ordering and kitchen; their POS stays cashier and tax system	Switch the guest QR off
Covered by ETA e-receipts	HIGH	Never replace the cashier until ETA is built	Nothing to roll back
Multi-branch group	MEDIUM	Pilot one branch, copy the setup to the rest	Per branch
Hotel, club, food court	MEDIUM	One outlet at a time, away from event days	Per outlet

Data checklist

Menu, prices, photos, tables and zones, staff, tax and service charge, hours. Import into a private copy. Owner signs a printed price sheet. Print and test every QR on two phone types. Change all default logins.

Training

Owner 60 minutes. **Waiters** a 20-minute drill. **Kitchen** 15 minutes. Everyone gets a printed Arabic card for when the screen or internet fails.

Never during service

Changing prices, taxes or table numbers. Deploying a new version. Resetting statistics. Moving a venue to another tier without telling the staff.

HANDOVER RECORD

What was installed and which tier. Who holds which login. Backup schedule and last restore test. Support hours and WhatsApp number. Known limits, such as no ETA and no offline mode. The date the old process may be retired. Signed by the owner and by you.

Chapter ten

The sales study guide

Everything to learn before you walk into an owner's café. Read it twice, then rehearse the demo on your own phone.

THE ONE-LINE PITCH

"Your guests order from their phones, your kitchen sees it at once, and you see every pound, for less than one waiter's daily wage."

ARABIC OPENER

"عايز أوريك في ١٠ دقايق إزاي تقلل ضغط الويترز وتشوف مبيعاتك لحظة بلحظة."

Have a native speaker polish the wording before you print it.

YOUR THREE PROOFS

Live demo on their phone. A free one-table QR trial for a week. Your written promise that the old process stays until they sign.

The 10-minute demo, in order

MINUTES 0–1

Their phone scans a QR

Open the demo, scan, land on the Home screen with their name and colours. They see themselves first.

MINUTES 1–3

Order and watch the kitchen

Order two drinks from the phone. Show the kitchen screen ringing. Press the water button and show the alert with the table number.

MINUTES 3–5

The waiter and the bill

Accept the order, mark it ready, split the bill, pay in cash. Show the receipt.

MINUTES 5–8

The owner's screen

Open Analytics: today's revenue, best sellers, rush hours. Say: "this is what you do not know today."

MINUTES 8–10

Switch tier and close

Use the tier switcher to show Basic, Operations and VIP. Ask: "which of these hurts most today?"

Questions to ask the owner

- How many tables, how many waiters per shift?
- When is your rush, and what goes wrong in it?
- What do you use today: paper, a POS, another QR menu?
- Are you already registered for e-receipts?
- Who owns the decision: you, a partner, a manager?

- What do you pay monthly for software today?
- How often do prices change, and what does reprinting cost?
- Do you know your best-selling item and your profit this week?
- Do guests ask for water, napkins or the bill repeatedly?
- Do you have more than one branch or plan to?

Objections and answers

THE OWNER SAYS	YOU ANSWER
“It is too expensive.”	Compare with a cloud POS at 1,500–3,000 EGP a month plus 7,500–22,000 EGP of hardware. Offer the entry tier at 350 EGP and upgrade later.
“Our guests won’t scan.”	Start with one table for a week. Count scans. Staff hand the QR card to the first table of every shift.
“What if the internet stops?”	The old process stays on the counter. An offline queue is on the roadmap; say so plainly.
“I am happy with my POS.”	Keep it. elmenue handles guest ordering and the kitchen beside it.
“Do you handle e-receipts?”	Not yet. If you must issue them today, keep your current cashier; we add the menu on top and bring ETA support on the roadmap.
“My cousin built me a menu for free.”	Ask whether it takes orders, rings the kitchen, tracks stock and reports profit.
“Let me think about it.”	Offer the free one-table trial now, with a fixed date to review the numbers together.

Negotiation rules

Give

A longer free trial, 20% off yearly, 10% off quarterly, a discount for being a pilot, the setup fee waived for a referral.

Trade

Every discount is traded for something: a testimonial, photos, a referral, a signed date. Never a bare price cut.

Hold

The monthly floor of 350 EGP, the one-time floor of 15,000 EGP, and the written handover before the old process is retired.

How to make it go boom in Egypt

LEVER	WHAT TO DO	FIRST STEP THIS MONTH
Proof	One pilot café that loves it beats a hundred pitches. Film their numbers with permission.	Pick two pilots in one neighbourhood
Clustering	Sell street by street. Owners watch each other; a second café down the road closes faster.	Choose one area and visit every venue
Referrals	One free month for the owner who refers a paying venue.	Write the offer on a card
Content	Short Arabic clips: "this café saved 40 waiter calls a night." Post on Instagram and Facebook; use WhatsApp for follow-up.	Record a 60-second demo
Partners	Menu printers, signage shops, coffee-machine and POS hardware dealers see owners daily. Pay them a commission per venue.	Visit three suppliers
Bundles	QR table stands, photography and menu design as one starter package.	Price the starter bundle
Upgrade path	Start at Basic, show ordering questions in the monthly report, upgrade within six months.	Draft the monthly report page
Trust	A contract, a tax invoice, a handover record, a WhatsApp number that answers.	Finish the contract templates

STUDY CHECKLIST

Know the three tiers and their prices by heart. Practice the 10-minute demo until you can do it without looking. Memorise the six objection answers. Know your floors. Know the e-receipt question and your honest answer. Carry the contract, the handover record and a printed QR table card.

Chapter eleven

Release log & next release

This chapter is updated after every verified addition. A code check on 29 October found that shift routes, a cashier screen with a Z-report and a feedback endpoint already exist in the code, so the next release completes and tests those rather than starting them again.

Next release: eight additions

FEATURE	TIER	BUILD EFFORT	NEEDS FROM YOU	STATUS
Plan limits on tables, staff, branches	All	2–3 days	Nothing	BUILT
Shift close and Z-report	All with POS	3–5 days (part exists)	A real 80 mm printer to test	BUILT
Guest feedback and Google reviews	Operations+	2–3 days (part exists)	Each venue's Google review link	BUILT
Upsell suggestions	Operations+	3–4 days	Nothing	BUILT
Coupons, timed offers, gift cards	Operations+ / gift cards VIP	6–8 days	Gift card amounts, stacking rules	BUILT
Offline order queue for staff	Operations+	5–7 days	Phones and tablet for testing	BUILT
Card and wallet payment at the table	Operations+	7–10 days	Paymob account, sandbox and live keys	BUILT · LIVE PAYMENT BLOCKED
ETA e-receipts	Operations+	15–25 days	ETA registration	BUILT · PRE-PRODUCTION BLOCKED

	and credentials

Effort is my estimate of working days with Claude Code and testing, not a promise. WhatsApp features are deliberately left out of this release. Every feature ships switched off for existing venues and is enabled one pilot at a time.

Release log

DATE	FEATURE	TIER	STATUS	WHAT CHANGED	TESTS PASSED
29 Oct 2026	F6 Plan limits	All	BUILT	Tables, staff and branches limits per tier, super override, usage bars; existing venues over a limit keep working	3 checks, both run modes
29 Oct 2026	F8 Shift close and Z-report	All with POS	BUILT	Open with float, paid in/out, X and Z reports, variance, sequential Z numbers, CSV	2 checks, both run modes
29 Oct 2026	F4 Feedback and Google reviews	Operations	BUILT	One rating per guest per visit, Google link for 4-5 stars, private alerts for 1-3, dashboard, CSV	2 checks, both run modes
29 Oct 2026	F1 Upsell suggestions	Operations	BUILT	Owner pairings then best sellers, metrics, CSV, non-destructive clear	2 checks, both run modes
29 Oct 2026	F5 Coupons, timed offers, gift cards	Operations / VIP	BUILT	Codes, happy-hour offers, gift cards, stacking switch, liability report; per-phone and item scope not built	3 checks, both run modes
29 Oct 2026	F7 Offline order queue	Operations	BUILT	Staff actions saved on the device and replayed once; payments never queued; browser queue still needs a device test	3 checks, both run modes
29 Oct	F2 Online card and	Operations	BUILT	Sandbox gateway and Paymob adapter,	4 checks, both run

2026	wallet payments			signed idempotent webhook, split bills; real payment blocked on a Paymob account	modes
29 Oct 2026	F3 ETA e-receipts	Operations	BUILT	Receipt builder, UUID chain, durable retry queue, export, QR; pre-production and production blocked on registration	4 checks, both run modes
29 Oct 2026	Release prompt and test plan	—	READY	Build prompt, 90+ test cases and the PDF rebuild script written; nothing built yet	—

Chapter twelve

Product audit & top 20 to build

Based on the code in the repository on 29 October 2026, including the uncommitted work on the `release/next` branch, plus the tests it contains. I read the code and did not run the tests. Competitor columns come from general market knowledge and the research earlier in this plan; verify before quoting them to an owner.

EXISTS in the main code ON BRANCH built on the branch, tests written, not run by me PARTIAL partly there MISSING not found in code, docs or UI

Score against the market

AREA	SCORE OUT OF 10	WHY
Product quality	7	Broad and mostly tested on the branch; stale docs, tracked backup and error files, no automatic test run on main
UX	7.5	Luxury look, six layouts, three languages; not yet tested with real owners
Restaurant features	6.5	Strong dine-in; missing modifiers, payments, ETA and pickup
Scalability	5	Whole venue stored as one document with polling every 2.5 seconds; fine for tens of venues, unproven for hundreds
AI readiness	5	Menu scan, rule-based copilot and upsell; model use needs an API key
Admin tools	7.5	Rich tabs, exports, audit; no restore or two-factor
Customer experience	7	Fast and polished; no pickup, no allergen info, no payment at table

What exists today

GROUP	STATUS	WHAT I FOUND	EVIDENCE
Menu management	EXISTS	Categories, items, photos (single and bulk), sold-out, dietary tags, timed categories, six layouts, drag ordering, Excel import and template, hero image	server.js item and category routes; admin Menu tab
Menu management	PARTIAL	AI photo menu scan. Real reading needs an Anthropic key; without it the demo returns a sample menu	server.js /menu/ocr
Menu management	MISSING	Item modifiers and options (size, sugar level, extra shot, add-ons). No code for it	no modifier or variant fields anywhere
Menu management	MISSING	Allergens, calories, spice level	only dietary tags exist
Ordering and QR	EXISTS	Table QR with secret key, shared table cart, review screen, pending window then server-enforced kitchen lock, party size, table host	tenant.js send_order, order_item_qty, order_cancel, host_set
Ordering and QR	MISSING	Guest pickup, takeaway or pre-order from a link without a table. Takeaway and delivery exist only as staff tickets	tenant.js open_ticket (staff only)
Ordering and QR	PARTIAL	Upsell suggestions in the cart with metrics and CSV export	tenant.js upsell_shown; /upsell routes; tests/f1_upsell.test.js (branch)
Customer experience	EXISTS	Home screen, Wi-Fi copy, promotions, language switch (English, Ammiya, Franco), light	customer.html, i18n.js

		and dark, profile, avatars, bill split self/table/custom, tip	
Customer experience	PARTIAL	Feedback and ratings after paying, with summary, CSV and handling. Google review link logic is in the engine; not confirmed end to end	server.js /feedback; tests/f4 (branch)
Restaurant website	MISSING	A real venue web page (menu, hours, map, social, reviews). The tenant page only shows staff links	public/tenant.html
POS and cashier	EXISTS	Staff ordering, takeaway and delivery tickets, discounts with captain cap, voids with reason, cash/card/mixed, change, tips, 80 mm receipt reprint, move and merge tables, reservations (staff side)	pos.js, cashier.html, captain.html
POS and cashier	ON BRANCH	Shifts: open with float, cash movements, X report, Z report with sequence number, exports	server.js /shift routes; tests/f8 (branch)
Kitchen	EXISTS	Station boards (kitchen and bar), timers, ready alerts to waiter and guest, one-tap sold-out	kitchen.html
Kitchen	PARTIAL	Automatic kitchen ticket printing. Receipt printing helper exists; ticket routing to printers does not	public/escpos.js
Waiter tools	EXISTS	Floor map and zone list, micro-service alerts with sound, push alerts, installable app, move/merge, host reassign	captain.html, sw.js

Inventory	EXISTS	Stock counts per item, low-stock alerts, waste, movement log	server.js /stock-log
Inventory	MISSING	Recipe costing, supplier purchase orders, automatic deduction by recipe	no code
Payments	MISSING	Online card and wallet payment (Paymob, Fawry, InstaPay). Cash and card recording only	no payment provider code
Payments	MISSING	ETA e-receipts (Egyptian tax authority)	no integration
Loyalty	EXISTS	Phone-number card, EGP-to-points and redemption ratios, members list, manual adjust (VIP)	features.js, /loyalty
Loyalty	MISSING	Phone verification (SMS or other) and consent. Anyone who knows a number can see its points	SPEC_COVERAGE.md known limit
Marketing	ON BRANCH	Coupons, timed offers (happy hour), gift cards with ledger, promo report	server.js /coupons /offers /gifts /promo/report; tests/f5 (branch)
CRM and marketing	MISSING	Customer database with segments, campaigns, birthday offers	only loyalty members list
Analytics	EXISTS	Revenue and profit vs previous period, by day and hour, by category, best sellers, rush hours, table usage, per-block CSV export and non-destructive clear	admin Analytics, /analytics

Reports	EXISTS	Excel and CSV reports, orders with reprint, discounts, voids, sales by staff, full JSON backup, audit trail	server.js /report /export.json
Mobile	EXISTS	Responsive guest app, installable staff PWA, push notifications (real phone delivery untested)	manifest.webmanifest, sw.js
Multi-branch	PARTIAL	Branch groups with revenue per branch for VIP. No central menu, no cross-branch sync	admin Branches tab
Offline	ON BRANCH	Staff offline action queue with idempotency keys and replay	tenant.js and shared.js idempotency; tests/f7 (branch)
Plans and limits	ON BRANCH	Per-plan limits on branches, tables and staff, enforced on creation only, with override	features.js limits; tests/f6 (branch)
Platform	EXISTS	Super admin: tenants, tiers, suspension, custom domain, branch group, subscription revenue; demo showroom with tier switcher	super.html, showroom
AI	PARTIAL	Admin copilot is keyword-based; a model answers the rest only if an API key is set	features.js copilot
Enterprise	MISSING	Public API, webhooks, integrations with accounting or delivery apps	no code

Security	PARTIAL	Hashed passwords and PINs, signed tokens, tenant checks, rate-limited feedback. No two-factor login for the owner, no self-service backup restore	auth.js, server.js

How it compares

FEATURE	ELMENUE	TYPICAL MARKET	MARKET LEADER
Menu look and themes	Strong: 6 layouts, 27 themes	Standard template	FineDine, MenuTiger (rich visual menus)
Guest ordering with bill split	Strong, Arabic-first	Ordering, rarely split	Toast, Square (pay at table)
Item modifiers and options	Missing	Yes	Toast, Square, Foodics, Lightspeed
Pickup and online ordering	Missing	Yes	GloriaFood (free), Toast, Foodics
POS and table management	Good	Yes	Toast, Oracle Micros, TouchBistro
Kitchen display	Good	Yes	Toast, Micros
Inventory	Counts and waste	Counts	Micros, Toast, Foodics (recipes, suppliers)
Integrated payments	Missing	Yes	Toast, Square, Foodics with Paymob
Loyalty	Phone points, VIP only	Paid add-on	Toast, Square, Foodics
CRM and campaigns	Missing	Basic email or SMS	Toast, Square
Analytics	Good for a small venue	Basic	Foodics BI, Toast, Micros
Multi-branch	Partial	Central menu	Foodics, Micros, Lightspeed

Offline mode	Staff queue on branch	Partial	Toast, Square, Micros
Local tax compliance (ETA)	Missing	Varies	Foodics and Odoo partners advertise it
AI features	Menu scan, copilot, upsell	Rare	Toast (ToastIQ)
Price for a small venue	450–1,450 EGP a month	200–1,500 EGP a month	Loyverse and GloriaFood have free plans

Missing features, rated

FEATURE	BUSINESS IMPACT	DIFFICULTY	BUILD TIME	REVENUE	RETENTION	BUI
Item modifiers and options	High	Medium	1–2 weeks	High	High	Yes
Card and wallet payment (Paymob)	High	Hard	2–3 weeks plus account setup	High	High	Yes
ETA e-receipts	High	Very hard	3–6 weeks plus registration	High	High	Yes
Guest pickup and pre-order link	High	Medium	1–2 weeks	High	Medium	Yes
Venue mini-website	High	Easy	3–5 days	Medium	Medium	Yes

Allergens, calories, spice	Medium	Easy	1–2 days	Low	Medium	Yes
Loyalty phone verification and consent	Medium	Medium	3–5 days plus SMS provider	Medium	Medium	Yes
Customer CRM and segments	Medium	Medium	1–2 weeks	High	High	Yes
Guest reservations and waitlist	Medium	Medium	1–2 weeks	Medium	Medium	Late
Central menu across branches	Medium	Medium	1–2 weeks	Medium	High	Late
Automatic kitchen ticket printing	Medium	Medium	1 week	Low	Medium	Late

Recipe costing and supplier orders	Medium	Hard	4–6 weeks	Medium	High	Late
Public API and webhooks	Low	Medium	1–2 weeks	Low	Medium	Late
Owner two-factor login	Medium	Easy	2–3 days	Low	Medium	Yes
Self-service backup restore	Medium	Medium	3–5 days	Low	Medium	Yes
Shared guest loyalty wallet across venues	High	Hard	4–6 weeks	High	High	Late
Benchmark report vs similar venues	High	Medium	2 weeks once 20+ venues	Medium	High	Late
Delivery driver tracking and aggregator links	Medium	Very hard	Months	Medium	Low	No

Accounting, HR and payroll	Low	Very hard	Months	Low	Low	No

Quick wins, best return first

FEATURE	EFFORT	VALUE	PRIORITY
Allergens, calories, spice level	1–2 days	Medium	1
Owner two-factor login	2–3 days	Medium	2
Go-live checklist inside admin (follows your rollout plan)	2–3 days	High: cuts your support time	3
Shareable receipt page and link	2–3 days	Medium	4
Venue mini-website with hours, map, social, Google link	3–5 days	High	5
Counter or kiosk mode (guest app on a counter tablet)	2–4 days	High for takeaway cafés	6
AI review summary of feedback comments	2–3 days	Medium	7
Slow-hour offer suggestions from analytics	3–4 days	Medium	8
Finish and verify the eight features on the release branch	1–2 weeks	High	9

What to build, and when

HORIZON	BUILD
Immediate (1–2 weeks)	Verify the release branch with the full test run. Start ETA and Paymob paperwork now because approvals take longest. Allergens, owner two-factor, go-live checklist, receipt link. Clean the repo: remove tracked backup and error files, refresh the docs.
Short term (1–2 months)	Item modifiers. Paymob payment. Guest pickup link. Venue mini-website. Loyalty phone verification. Counter mode. Customer export.
Mid term (3–6 months)	ETA e-receipts live. Guest reservations. Central menu. CRM segments. Benchmark report. AI review and offer suggestions. Printer routing.
Long term (6+ months)	Shared guest loyalty wallet. Recipe costing and suppliers. Public API. Demand forecasting. Delivery partner integrations if chains demand it.

Never build

FEATURE	WHY NOT	DO INSTEAD
Own payment gateway or wallet	Needs a central bank licence and heavy compliance	Integrate Paymob and Fawry instead
Delivery driver app and GPS tracking	A second business with its own operations	Link to existing delivery apps later
Full accounting, HR and payroll	Huge scope, entrenched rivals	Export to the accountant
Branded native iOS and Android apps per venue	Store review, cost per venue	The web app and installable PWA already do the job
Self-service kiosk hardware	Hardware, repairs, logistics	Offer counter mode on a tablet the venue owns
Consumer marketplace app like a food-discovery site	Needs millions of users and ad spend	Own the venue side only
Multi-currency and global tax engines	Not your market	Stay Egypt-first
Sending orders by WhatsApp in this release	You decided to leave it out	Revisit after payments and ETA

AI opportunities

IDEA	DIFFICULTY	COST	REVENUE POTENTIAL	DO FIRST?
Smart upselling	Easy	Low: rules exist, a model is optional	Medium	Yes. Already on branch; improve with sales data
AI review analysis	Easy	Low per summary	Medium	Yes
AI offer suggestions for slow hours	Easy	Low	Medium	Yes, as rules first
AI customer segmentation	Medium	Low	Medium	After CRM exists
AI marketing copy and campaigns	Medium	Low	Medium	After CRM exists
Personalised menu ordering	Hard	Medium	Medium	No: needs far more guest data
Demand forecasting	Hard	Medium	Medium	No: needs months of history
AI recommendations per guest	Hard	Medium	Medium	Later with the shared wallet
Guest-facing AI chatbot	Medium	Medium	Low	No: adds support risk

WhatsApp opportunities

IDEA	DIFFICULTY	BUSINESS VALUE	RECOMMENDATION
WhatsApp ordering	Hard	High in Egypt	Defer, after payments
WhatsApp waiter call	Medium	Low: the QR button is faster	Skip
WhatsApp reservation	Medium	Medium	Defer
WhatsApp loyalty	Medium	High	Defer; pairs with phone verification
WhatsApp promotions	Medium	High	Defer; rules on templates and opt-in apply
WhatsApp feedback collection	Easy to medium	Medium	Defer; the in-app form already collects it

You asked to leave WhatsApp out of the release. A plain click-to-chat link on the venue page costs almost nothing and needs no business API, so it is the one exception worth taking.

Technical debt and risks

- Whole venue is one JSON document saved with compare-and-swap. Busy venues will see more save retries as order volume grows.
- Guests and staff poll the server every 2.5 seconds on Vercel. Cost and delay grow with venues; plan a real-time server for larger tenants.
- Large single-file pages (customer, admin, captain) with inline script. Fast to build, harder to maintain and test.
- .old_server.js.bak and .local.err are tracked in git.
- Docs (SPEC_COVERAGE, PROJECT_GUIDE) no longer match the code: shifts, feedback, coupons and limits are not described.
- Eight features exist only on the release/next branch; I have not run its tests.
- Loyalty identifies people by phone number only, with no verification.
- Copilot is keyword-based; real answers depend on an optional API key and its cost.
- Secrets were shared in chats earlier (your own security to-do): rotate them.

Top 20 features to build next

#	FEATURE	WHY IT MATTERS	DIFFICULTY	REVENUE IMPACT	PRIORITY
1	Item modifiers and options	Cafés cannot take real orders without size, sugar and extras	Medium	High	Now
2	Card and wallet payment (Paymob)	Revenue share, stickiness, closes the biggest gap	Hard	High	Now
3	ETA e-receipts	Unlocks venues that are legally covered	Very hard	High	Start paperwork now
4	Guest pickup and pre-order link	Takeaway without staff tickets; standard in the market	Medium	High	Next
5	Venue mini-website	A link for Instagram and Google; helps you sell	Easy	Medium	Next
6	Go-live checklist in admin	Cuts your onboarding and support hours	Easy	High (saves cost)	Now
7	Owner two-factor login and restore	Protects every venue and your reputation	Easy to medium	Medium	Now
8	Loyalty phone verification and consent	Required before real customer data	Medium	Medium	Next
9	Customer CRM and segments	Turns data into repeat visits and VIP upgrades	Medium	High	Mid

10	Counter or kiosk mode	Fits takeaway cafés with one tablet	Easy	Medium	Next
11	Allergens, calories, spice	Trust, tourists and families	Easy	Low	Now
12	Shareable receipt link	Digital receipts without paper; ties to ETA	Easy	Low	Next
13	Guest reservations and waitlist	Fills quiet hours	Medium	Medium	Mid
14	AI review summary	Owners read one paragraph, not 200 comments	Easy	Medium	Next
15	AI slow-hour offers	Suggests happy hours from your own data	Easy	Medium	Mid
16	Benchmark report vs similar venues	A reason to stay subscribed	Medium	High (retention)	Mid
17	Central menu across branches	Needed to sell to chains	Medium	Medium	Mid
18	Public API and webhooks	Partners and integrations	Medium	Low	Later
19	Shared guest loyalty wallet	Your strongest moat; grows with each venue	Hard	High	Later
20	Recipe costing and supplier orders	Value for bigger venues	Hard	Medium	Later

Ranking is my judgement of return against effort for an Egyptian independent café, not a measurement. Re-rank after the first three pilots tell you what owners actually ask for.

Chapter thirteen

Twelve-month roadmap

DAYS 1–14

Foundations

- Register business and tax card
- Rotate keys, leave Vercel free
- Backups and staging

Gate · backup restores cleanly

DAYS 15–30

Readiness

- Contract, invoice, handover
- Automated tests, rollback drill
- Arabic demo video

Gate · rollback under 5 minutes

DAYS 31–60

Pilots

- 2–3 venues at 30–40% off
- Fix pilot bugs
- Shift close and Z-report

Gate · totals match 5 days

DAYS 61–90

First sales

- Arabic landing page
- First full-price venues
- Decide ETA: build or partner

Gate · 3 paying venues

MONTHS 4–6

Reliability

- 10 venues, referral offer
- ETA e-receipts
- Offline queue, loyalty SMS check

Gate · 30 days, no blocking bug

MONTHS 7–9

Revenue depth

- VIP upsells and chains
- Card payments
- WhatsApp and feedback

Gate · card flow tested

MONTHS 10–12

Scale

- 25 venues, first support hire
- Recipes and purchasing
- Cross-branch menu sync

Gate · under 6 support hours per venue

What success looks like

MEASURE	TARGET
Pilot to paid	2 of 3
Signing to go-live	Under 5 weeks
Uptime of guest and staff pages	99.5% or better
Support tickets per venue per month	Under 4 after month two
Monthly churn	Under 3%
Basic to Operations upgrades	25% within six months
Monthly recurring revenue	10,000 EGP by month six, 30,000 by month twelve

Chapter fourteen

Risks & open questions

RISK	IMPACT	RESPONSE
Venue must issue ETA e-receipts	Cannot sell to them	Ask at first meeting; build or partner early
Outage during rush	Lost trust	Shadow-first rollout, paper backup card, off-hours releases, rollback
Wi-Fi or internet failure	Orders stall	Router advice now, offline queue on the roadmap
Data loss or breach	Could end the business	Off-site backups, tenant isolation tests, rotated secrets
Loyalty phone numbers exposed	Privacy claim	SMS verification and a privacy clause before real data
Support drains your time	No growth	One free month, written response times, training video
Copying or resale	Lost revenue	You host it; licence terms; sell a service, not source code
Pound moves	Hosting cost rises	Quote expiry; review prices every six months
Solo-developer dependency	Stall if unavailable	Runbook and an up-to-date project guide

Decisions still open

Sole proprietorship or company, and who your accountant is. Which city and venue type come first. Your own server, or Vercel Pro with Supabase Pro. Real quotes from Dgtera, VeraKit360 and Zlenu's paid plans, requested as a customer.

A note on the figures

Costs, break-even and tax points come from your Egypt market study and are estimates. Tax, registration and contract wording need an accountant and a lawyer before you rely on them.

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